



February 2024

2023-24 Annual Enrollment Trend Report Executive Summary

Background

BVSD has been anticipating a gradual decline in enrollment in future years. COVID-related enrollment loss accelerated this decline dramatically. Declining numbers of students can lead to budget reductions, inefficient facility operations and most importantly, a less comprehensive educational experience for students at schools with smaller populations.

In April 2022, the Board created the Long Range Advisory Committee (LRAC) to involve the community in guiding the district's response to enrollment decline. In June 2023, the committee provided the Board with a [final report of recommendations](#). The recommendations included a process and metrics for when the Board should take action related to the enrollment at a particular school. In addition, the committee recommended that, beginning in February 2024, the Board should receive an annual enrollment trend report from staff regarding school utilization which would also include the number of classes per grade level and five-year enrollment projections by school.

Annual Enrollment Trend Report

Based on the metrics and data presented in the report, particular schools may be identified for either the Enrollment Advisory Phase or the Community Engagement Phase:

ENROLLMENT ADVISORY PHASE

If an elementary school has **fewer than two classes per grade level** and enrollment is **less than 60% of capacity**, the Board and community should be aware:

- Resource allocation will adhere to the established staffing funding formula to the greatest extent possible.
- Multi-age classrooms may be necessary to meet the funding formula.
- Library, counseling, and specials may be limited.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT PHASE

If an elementary school's enrollment **continues to decline below 50% capacity** and **fewer than 1.5 average classes per grade level** with a projected trend to continue for at least 5 years, the Board will engage staff to lead a community-based process to develop possible solutions to

provide a thriving, well-resourced educational environment for students and staff. Decision-making should be in the context of looking at geographic areas or multiple schools if appropriate. Timeline will be established by the Board.

This process may result in recommendations that could include but are not limited to:

- Continuing to operate at the established staffing funding formula
- Focus or specialized programming
- Reallocate grade levels with neighboring school
- Closure/Consolidation

Enrollment and Capacity Projections

In December, staff shared the updated annual enrollment data and an analysis of trends. The Annual Enrollment Trend Report further evaluates this data in terms of each school's capacity; what the enrollment count will look like in terms of the number of classes at each grade level for each school; and 5-year projections for these data points. The report also identifies what these numbers mean for schools in terms of the LRAC enrollment metrics.

For the 2023-24 school year, there are six schools that are in the Enrollment Advisory Phase (Coal Creek, Community Montessori, Eldorado K-5, Flatirons, Kohl, and Mesa) meaning that they are ≤ 2.0 rounds or are at $\leq 60\%$ capacity. One school, Heatherwood, is in the Community Engagement Phase, meaning it is at ≤ 1.5 classes per grade and $\leq 50\%$ capacity.

Projections indicate that in the next five years, enrollment will continue to decline throughout the district, and by 2028-29, BVSD will have seven schools at the Enrollment Advisory Phase and six at the Community Engagement Phase. These schools are distributed with nine in Boulder, one in Louisville, one in Superior, and two in Broomfield.

Community Engagement Phase for Heatherwood

Since Heatherwood has met the metrics for the Community Engagement Phase, staff is planning to launch a Community Engagement Process at the beginning of March. Details of the process will be shared at the Feb. 27 Board meeting.